M-C-301E
June 21, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. M-C-301D
December 12, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHINA TABLEWARE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers vitrified non-porcelain china tableware for mess facilities.

1.2 Classification. China tableware shall be of the item and article specified in table VI (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 7350

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Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

C 368 - Standard Method of Test for Impact Resistance of Ceramic Tableware.
C 738 - Standard Method of Test for Lead and Cadmium Extracted from Glazed Ceramic Surfaces.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa. 19103).

U.S. Department of Health, Education, and Welfare (HEW):

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W. Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, sample tableware items shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

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3.2 Materials. Material shall consist of clay, feldspar, flint, and metallic oxide of a quality customarily used for the manufacture of commercial grade chinaware.

3.3 Design and shape. The tableware shall conform to the design and shape detailed in individual drawings for the items listed in table VI (see table III). The foot configuration for cups (items 27, 39, 42, and 44 through 46) shall be at the option of the manufacturer.

3.4 Measurements.

3.4.1 Dimensions. The tableware listed in table VI shall conform to the dimensional requirements as shown on the individual drawings (see table III).

3.4.2 Capacity. The hollow ware (bowls, cups, and pitchers) shall conform to the capacity requirement in table VI for the specified item (see 4.4.2).

3.4.3 Out-of-round. The out-of-roundness of flatware (fruit dishes, plates, and saucers) shall not exceed 0.062 inch on the largest diameter. The out-of-roundness of hollow ware (bowls and cups, only) shall not exceed 0.094 inch on the largest diameter (see 4.5.7).

3.4.4 Edge warpage and slope. The edge warpage and slope of the flatware shall not exceed 0.078 inch and two degrees, respectively, when measured in accordance with 4.5.8.

3.4.5 Flatness of dinner plate. The eating surface of the dinner plate shall be flat within 0.070 inch total indicator runout when measured in accordance with 4.5.9.

3.5 Weight. The tableware shall conform to the weight limitations in table VI, when determined in accordance with 4.4.2.

3.6 Impact and chipping. Tableware specified in table I shall meet the impact strength and chipping resistance requirements indicated when tested in accordance with 4.5.1 and 4.5.2.

TABLE I. Impact strength and chipping resistance

Item No.	Article	Impact (ft. lbs.)	Chipping (ft. lbs.)
10	Plate, plain edge, bread and butter	0.18	0.10
16	Plate, plain edge, dessert or salad	0.18	0.075
21	Plate, plain edge	0.18	0.075
22	Plate, narrow rim	0.18	0.075
25	Plate, narrow rim	0.20	0.15
44	Cup, coffee or tea	0.06	
45	Cup, coffee or tea	0.06	
46	Cup, coffee or tea	0.10	
47	Cup, mug	0.10	
51	Saucer, cup, narrow rim	0.18	0.075
55	Saucer, cup, plain edge	0.18	0.075

3.7 Thermal shock. Tableware shall resist thermal shock as specified in 4.5.3.

3.8 Absorption. Tableware shall be nonabsorbent when whole. Pieces of broken ware tested as specified in 4.5.4 shall have not more than a 0.2 percent average absorption value for a sample unit with a maximum dimension less than 10 inches. The average absorption of a sample unit having a maximum dimension of 10 inches or more shall not exceed 0.5 percent.

3.9 Wetability. Tableware shall possess the property of wetting with hot water, without aid of wetting agents, and even drying. Tableware shall display a smooth film when tested in accordance with 4.5.5.

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3.10 Marking for identification. Tableware shall be permanently and distinctly marked in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice. Marking shall be on the bottom of the ware with the name of the manufacturer, brand name, or trademark of such known character as to be readily identifiable with the manufacturer, and the date of manufacture or manufacturer's code for such date. If a coded date is used, the contracting officer shall be provided with the code key.

3.11 Finish. Except for the resting surface of hollow ware, the entire surface of the china tableware items shall be covered by a uniform and continuous hard impervious glaze which is cleanable and retains this quality. In addition, the resting surface of items other than hollow ware shall be nonabrasive in texture after glazing.

3.11.1 Release of heavy metals. The lead release of the glaze and the release of other heavy metals shall fall within the limits intended by Section 402 (a)(2)(c) of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. Lead release shall not exceed 7 parts per million (ppm) and cadmium release shall not exceed 0.5 ppm when tested in accordance with 4.5.6.

3.12 Decoration (see 6.2). Tableware shall be plain, undecorated or decorated as specified by the contract or purchase order (see table III).

3.12.1 Veterans Administration. Decoration shall be Greenfield Print Pattern of the designated motif for the specified item of tableware below (see figure 1). Decoration shall be underglaze and of the design and placement for the specified item (see figures 1-A through 1-H). All details of the design shall be not lighter than color chip No. 14090 nor darker than color chip No. 14109 of Fed. Std. No. 595. Shading and density of color shall conform to sample motif available from the contracting officer.

Item No.	Article	Motif	Figure No.
4	Bowl, soup	D	1-A
6	Dish, fruit	D	1-B
10	Plate, bread and butter	C	1-C
21	Plate, 9-inch	B	1-D
22	Plate, 8-1/4-inch	B	1-E
46	Cup, coffee or tea	C	1-F
47	Cup, mug	C	1-G
51	Saucer, cup	D	1-H

3.12.2 Department of the Army. Decoration shall be an underglazed maroon band 0.125 inch wide. Maroon band shall be located on the upper exposed-to-view surface of the flatware (dishes, plates, and saucers) 0.125 inch from the outer edge. Maroon band shall be located on the outer surface of hollow ware (bowls, cups, and pitchers) 0.125 inch from the top edge.

3.12.3 Department of the Navy. Decoration shall be as specified in 3.12.3.1, 3.12.3.2, or 3.12.3.3.

3.12.3.1 Flag officers. Decoration shall consist of gilt band 0.125 inch wide, dark blue line and gilt line 0.031 inch wide, and distinguishing mark. The gilt line shall be omitted from item 31 (pickle dish) due to its inside configuration. The dark blue line shall be underglaze and all other decorations shall be coin gold over glaze. Distinguishing mark shall be A or B for the specified item (see table II) and in accordance with figure 2. Placement of the decoration shall be as specified for the representative items in figures 2-A through 2-F, as applicable.

3.12.3.2 Officers' mess. Decoration shall be dark blue and shall consist of band 0.156 inch wide, line 0.031 inch wide, and distinguishing mark (anchor). Dark blue line shall be omitted from item 31 (see 3.12.3.1). All decorations shall be underglaze. In addition, cup items with handles shall be decorated with an inverted triangular marking on the outside grasping surface of the handle. Distinguishing mark shall be size 5 or 6 for the specified item (see table II) and in accordance with figure 3. Placement of the decoration shall be as specified for the representative items in figures 3-A through 3-F, as applicable.

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TABLE II. Distinguishing marks

Item No.	Article	Mark sizes Seal	Anchor
9	Dish, fruit	-	5
12	Plate, bread and butter	B	5
16	Plate, dessert or salad	B	5
18	Plate, soup, 7-inch	B	5
20	Plate, soup, 9-1/8-inch	A	6
21	Plate, 9-inch	A	6
26	Plate, 10-inch	A	6
27	Cup, egg	A	6
31	Dish, pickle	B	5
39	Cup, demitasse	B	5
42	Cup, bouillon	A	6
45	Cup, coffee or tea	A	6
50	Saucer, cup, demitasse	B	5
55	Saucer, cup	A	6

3.12.3.3 General purpose ware. Decoration shall be an underglazed dark blue band 0.125 inch wide. Dark blue band shall be located on the upper exposed-to-view surface of the flatware (dishes, plates, and saucers) 0.125 inch from the outer edge. Dark blue band shall be located on the outer surface of hollow ware (bowls, cups, and pitchers) 0.125 inch from the top edge.

3.12.3.4 Color. The dark blue of the decorated ware in 3.12.3.1, 3.12.3.2, and 3.12.3.3 shall be not lighter than color chip No. 15102 nor darker than color chip No. 15050 of Fed. Std. No. 595.

3.12.4 Tolerance.

3.12.4.1 Placement. A tolerance of plus or minus 0.062 inch shall be allowed in the placement of the decoration.

3.12.4.2 Width. A tolerance of plus or minus 0.0156 inch shall be allowed on the width of decorative bands and plus or minus 0.0078 inch on decorative lines.

3.13 Workmanship. The tableware shall be constructed uniformly within the tolerances specified and shall be free from defects affecting appearance and serviceability.

.4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample. Inspection and testing of the preproduction sample shall be for all applicable provisions of this specification. The sample for inspection shall be one completely fabricated end item. The sample for testing shall be in accordance with 4.3.3.

4.3 Sampling. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be made in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of all tableware of the same item, design and shape submitted for inspection at the same time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated end item.

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Random samples shall be selected according to level II.

4.3.3 Sampling for tests. The sample shall be six units of the same tableware randomly selected from each lot.

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4.4 Inspection.

4.4.1 End item. Tableware shall be examined for defects listed in table III. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed as defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of defects, end item

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Appearance	Large kiln dirt (unground) 0.032 inch or larger	X	
	Kiln dirt (unground) less than 0.032 inch or glaze grinding mark.		
	Four or more on face	X	
	Five or more on back		X
Workmanship	Cracks--one or more	X	
	Chips, gouges, or creases--one or more (chips less than 0.062 inch large on edge and 0.125 inch on foot which are glazed over are not a defect)	X	
	Lack of uniformity in texture and finish (includes speckles and bulges)	X	
	Large spot (0.062 inch or larger). One on face; two or more on back	X	
	Small spot (0.007 inch or larger but less than 0.062 inch).		
	Four or more on face	X	
	Five or more on back		X
	Large open pinhole or pimple (center 0.016 inch or larger)	X	
	Small open pinhole or pimple (center 0.007 inch or larger but less than 0.016 inch).		
	Four or more on face	X	
	Five or more on back		X
	Combined defects of small spots (0.007 inch or larger but less than 0.062 inch); small open pinhole or pimple (center 0.007 inch or larger but less than 0.016 inch); and kiln dirt (unground) less than 0.032 inch or glaze grinding mark.		
	Four or more on face	X	
	Five or more on back		X
	Absence of complete glazing (see 3.11)	X	
	Bare spots in glaze	X	
	Ground pin or fixture mark on back.		
	Larger than 0.375 inch on round-shaped flatware	X	
	Larger than 0.375 by 0.625 inch on oval-shaped flatware	X	
	Blister--one or more	X	
	Heavy glaze resulting in open air-bubbles or greenish glaze	X	
Construction	Warpage--so crooked that piece rocks on its own foot or will produce an unstable bung	X	
	Misplaced handle on holloware--one that is so far off that it detracts from the appearance and/or function of the cup	X	
	Corner and edges sharp	X	
Decorations, distinguishing marks, and trim (as specified in 3.12)	Smudged decoration		X
	Decoration misplacement	X	
	Not color specified	X	
	Irregular color band or line	X	

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TABLE III. Classification of defects, end item (cont'd)

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Dimensions	Not within the allowed tolerance for the specified item (see 3.4.1).....	X	
Design and shape	Not of specified design or shape (see 3.3).....	X	
Marking for identification	Not as specified in 3.10.....		X

4.4.2 Capacity and weight. Tableware selected in accordance with 4.3.2 shall be measured for brimful (up to brim) capacity in conformance with 3.4.2 and weighed for conformance with 3.5. A laboratory beaker or other suitable liquid measure graduated in ounces and fractions thereof shall be used to measure capacity. A scale graduated in ounces and fractions thereof shall be used to determine weight. AQL shall be 2.5, expressed in defects per hundred units.

4.4.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that the preservation, packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. Examination of packaging

Examine	Defect
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged or not conforming to the applicable specification or requirements stated herein.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as loose strapping, incomplete closure of container flaps, inadequate stapling or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity per container is more or less than specified; not of same description. Gross weight exceeds the requirement of the box specification.

4.4.4 Testing of the end item. Tableware selected in accordance with 4.3.3 shall be tested as specified in 4.5. The quantitative requirements of the sample unit used for the following tests shall be:

Test	Quantity
Impact strength.	3
Chipping resistance.	1
Thermal shock.	1
Lead and cadmium release	1

Except for absorption testing (see 4.5.4) and for wetability testing (see 4.5.5), no more than one test shall be performed on the same piece of tableware. Absorption testing shall be limited to those specimens used in the chipping resistance and the impact strength tests, but not subjected to the wetability test. Failure of any one test shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.5 Tests.

4.5.1 Impact strength. Impact strength tests shall be conducted on the items listed in table I for which impact strength is shown and the average of three specimens must equal the impact strength (foot poundage) requirements in that table. The ware shall be tested by using an apparatus similar to that shown in figure 4 or that shown in ASTM C 368.

4.5.1.1 Procedure. When testing a plate, saucer, or dish, the ware shall be supported against the three equally spaced 1/8 inch steel balls so that when the hammer is hanging vertically the impact point of the hammer touches the center of the bottom of the test piece. When testing a cup, the ware shall be rested on its foot between two cast iron blocks forming a 90° "V" whose sides are sufficiently high to support the upper edge of the cup. The blocks shall be so adjusted that when the hammer is hanging vertically, its impact point touches the cup at its upper edge and in the plane of the bisector of the angle of the "V". The test piece shall be repeatedly struck with the spherical end of the hammer at the same point until failure occurs. Beginning with the initial blow, the force of each succeeding blow shall be increased in the increments given in the following table:

	Initial blow (ft.-lb.)	Increment (ft.-lb.)
Plate, saucer, or dish	0.10	0.02
Cup (mug)	.10	.02
Tea cup	.02	.01

Failure of plates, saucers, and dishes is defined as the development of a rupture which appears as a hole through the body or as a body crack extending through the rim of the article. Failure of cups is defined as the development of a body crack extending into any portion of the foot or as the breaking away of a portion of the body.

4.5.2 Chipping resistance. Chipping resistance test shall be made on the items in table I for which a value is shown. The ware shall be tested by using the same apparatus in 4.5.1. Failure occurs when fragments of glaze and body are removed after repeated hammer blows on the edge of the sample. The sample shall be tested at three equally spaced points on its periphery and the results shall then be averaged to determine conformance with table I.

4.5.2.1 Rolled edge ware. The sample shall be placed on its foot between two cast iron blocks forming a 90° "V". The blocks shall be so adjusted that when the hammer is hanging vertically, the center of the impact face of the chipping hammer touches the edge of the sample at the plane of the bisector of the angle of the "V". Beginning with an initial blow of 0.10 ft. lb. and then increasing the force of each succeeding blow in increments of 0.02 ft. lb., the sample shall be repeatedly struck on the edge with the cylindrical end of the hammer until failure occurs.

4.5.2.2 Narrow rim or plain edge ware. The procedure shall be the same as in 4.5.2.1, except that the initial blow shall be 0.02 ft. lb. with an increment of 0.01 ft. lb.

4.5.3 Thermal shock. This test shall be conducted on any size plate. The plate shall be heated to 347°F, in an oven and then removed and immediately immersed in water at 68° F. The weight of ware to weight of water shall be not greater than 1 to 8. After cooling in the water, the plate shall be dried and then immersed in a dye solution. The dye shall be methyl violet 2B and when mixed in water shall be of sufficient concentration to indicate the presence of cracking or glaze crazing after the plate is cleaned. The sample piece shall be submitted to this test five times. Any indication of cracking or glaze crazing shall constitute failure.

10 —
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4.5.4 Absorption. Absorption test shall be made on glazed pieces having an area of approximately 2.5 square inches broken from three different samples used in the chipping or impact test. The pieces, after being dried to constant weight at 110°C, shall be completely immersed and vigorously boiled in water for 5 hours and then allowed to remain in the water for twenty hours. The pieces shall then be removed, wiped with a damp cloth to remove excess moisture, and immediately weighed to the nearest 0.01 gram. The percentage of absorption is computed from the formula:

$$\text{Percentage absorption} = \frac{\text{Wet weight-dry weight X 100}}{\text{Dry weight}}$$

4.5.5 Wetability. A section of a plate shall be cleaned by rubbing with ethyl alcohol (95 percent) and cotton. When dry, the plate shall be dipped in water. Absence of a uniform film adhering to the previously cleaned surface shall constitute failure.

4.5.6 Lead and cadmium release. Tableware shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C 738, except the sample shall be one unit of the same item (see 3.11.1).

4.5.7 Out of round. The out-of-roundness of the tableware (see 3.4.3) shall be determined by use of a dial indicator. The sample, resting on its foot on a flat surface, shall be blocked in a manner to allow its rotation. The indicator shall be stabilized to prevent a distorted reading. The indicator plunger shall strike the outer rim edge of the sample from above at a 45° angle to a horizontal plane. The sample shall be rotated and the low and high readings taken. The difference between the two readings shall denote the out-of-roundness.

4.5.8 Edge warpage and slope. Edge warpage and slope of items (see 3.4.4) shall be determined as follows:

(1) Invert sample and place face down on a surface plate.
(2) Place a weight across the resting surface of the item to stabilize it in place.
(3) Attempt to insert a feeler gauge of 0.078 inch between the surface and and any portion of the sample edge.
(4) Remove the weight from the resting surface and replace it with an inclinometer.
(5) Determine the slope of the resting surface.

4.5.9 Flatness. The surface flatness of the eating area of the dinner plates (see 3.4.5) shall be determined by using a dial indicator. The sample shall be adequately blocked and the indicator stabilized to prevent a distorted reading. The total runout (flatness) expressed in decimal value shall be the summation of the high (convex) and the low (concave) point encountered.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. The unit of issue shall be as specified in table V for the applicable item number. (For civil agencies only.)

5.1.2 Unit package quantities. The number of units of issue to be packaged in each unit package shall be as specified in table V for the applicable item number. (For civil agencies only.)

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Military. Tableware shall be adequately protected within the shipping containers against damage or breakage by liners, partitions, wrappers, excelsior, or other packing material. All liners and partitions shall be constructed of fiberboard conforming to type CF (A or C flute), class domestic, variety SW, grade 200 of PPP-F-320.

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5.1.4 Level B.

5.1.4.1 Civil agencies. Tableware, of one description only in quantities shown in table V, shall be unit packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The tableware shall be cushioned in the box with interior slotted or die-cut fiberboard partitions; molded pulp separators; protective pads; single-faced corrugated sleeves, tubes or pouches; individual wrapping with tissue paper; or by use of a combination of these cushioning materials to insure against breakage or damage during shipment or storage. Each box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.5 Level C. Tableware shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Unit of issue or unit packages. The number of units of issue or unit packages to be packed in each shipping container shall be as specified in table V. (For civil agencies only.)

TABLE V. Packaging quantities

Item No.	Unit of issue	Items per unit package	No. of units of issue or unit packages per shipping container	Items per shipping container
4 through 18	12	12	3	36
19 through 26	12	12	2	24
27	12	12	3	36
31	12		1	12
38	36		1	36
39 through 55	12	12	3	36

5.2.2 Level A.

5.2.2.1 Military. Tableware, of one description only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in overseas type or class boxes conforming to any of the following specifications: PPP-B-585, class 3 wood, wirebound, type 2 load; PPP-B-591, class II, style A fiberboard, wood-cleated, type 2 load; PPP-B-601, overseas type, style A, grade A or B, wood, cleated-plywood, type 2 load; PPP-B-621, class 2, style 4 wood nailed and lock-corner, type 2 load. Gross weight of boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds. Box closures and strapping shall conform to the box specifications and the appendix thereto. Boxes shall be provided with caseliners conforming to type I or II, grade B or C of MIL-L-10547, sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

5.2.2.2 Military. Alternatively, tableware of one description only shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style CCSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each fiberboard container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Each fiberboard container shall be closed method III, waterproofed method V, and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Gross weight of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

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5.2.3 Level B.

5.2.3.1 Military. Tableware of one description only packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style CSSC-L, type CF or SF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to class domestic, variety DW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed method II in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. Gross weight of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.3.1.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard container. When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed method III in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3.2 Civil agencies. The shipping container shall conform to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.4 Level C. Tableware shall be packed in containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. All marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. All marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The china tableware is intended for use by civil and military agencies in preparing, serving, and storing food.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Item required (see 1.2).
(c) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(d) Decoration, if any (see 3.12).
(e) Size of lot, if different from 4.3.1.
(f) Levels of preservation, packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Marking required (see 5.3).
(h) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.3.1.1).

6.3 Deletions. Items 1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 14, 15, 17, 23, 24, 28, 29, 30, 32 through 38, 40, 41, 43, 49, and 52 through 54 of M-C-301D have been deleted. Item 37a has been redesignated item 38 in this specification.

6.4 Inclusions. The requirements of the following Military Standards have been incorporated in this specification:

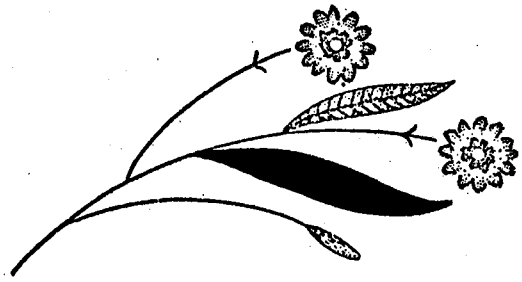
MS 16917 through MS 16929
MS 16934, MS 16991
MS 17200 through MS 17210
MS 17213

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MOTIF B

PLATE, DINNER



MOTIF C

CUP, COFFEE OR TEA
CUP, MUG
PLATE, BREAD AND BUTTER



MOTIF D

BOWL, SOUP
DISH, FRUIT
SAUCER, CUP

FIGURE 1. DECORATION - GREENFIELD PRINT PATTERN

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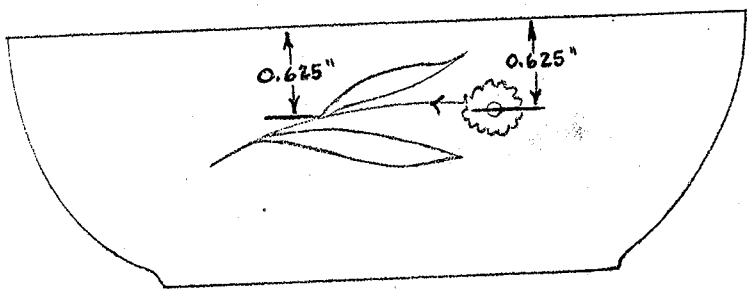


FIGURE 1-A. BOWL, SOUP (MOTIF D)

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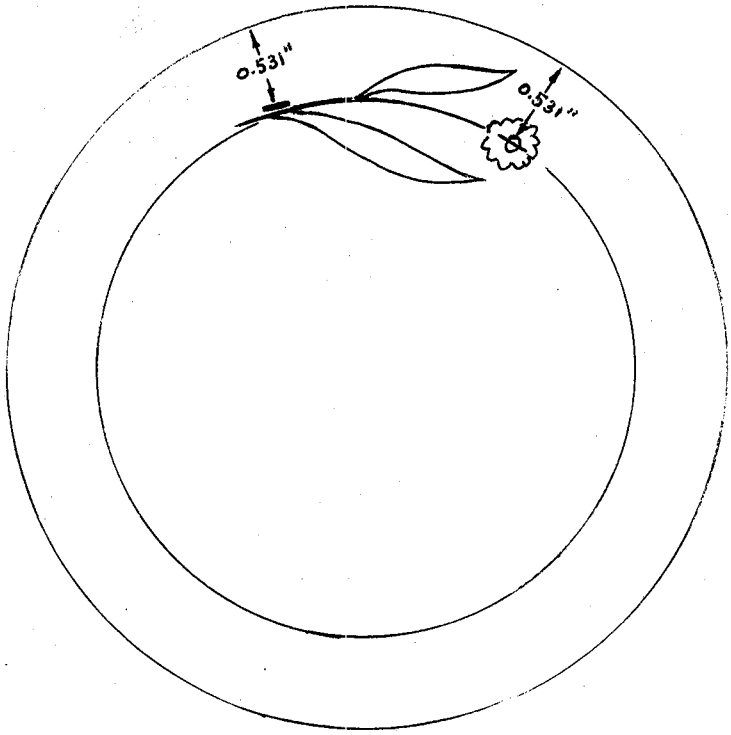


FIGURE 1-B. DISH, FRUIT (MOTIF D)

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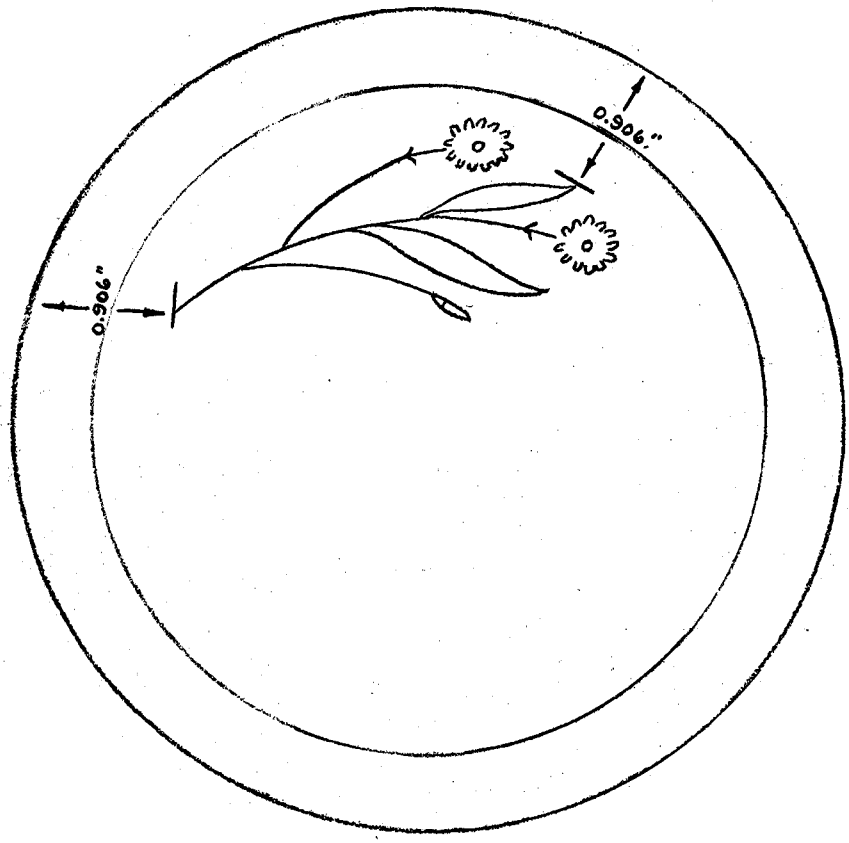


FIGURE 1-C. PLATE, BREAD AND BUTTER (MOTIF C)

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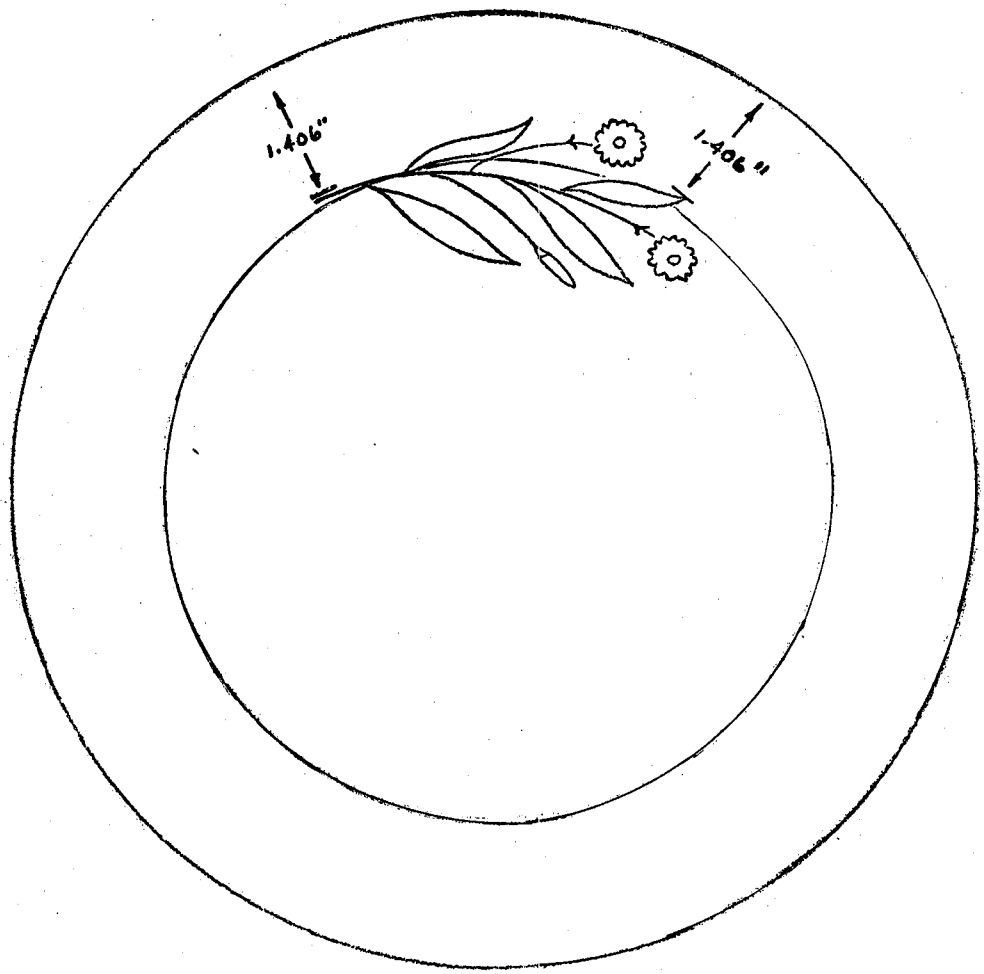


FIGURE 1-D. PLATE, 9-INCH (MOTIF B)

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Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

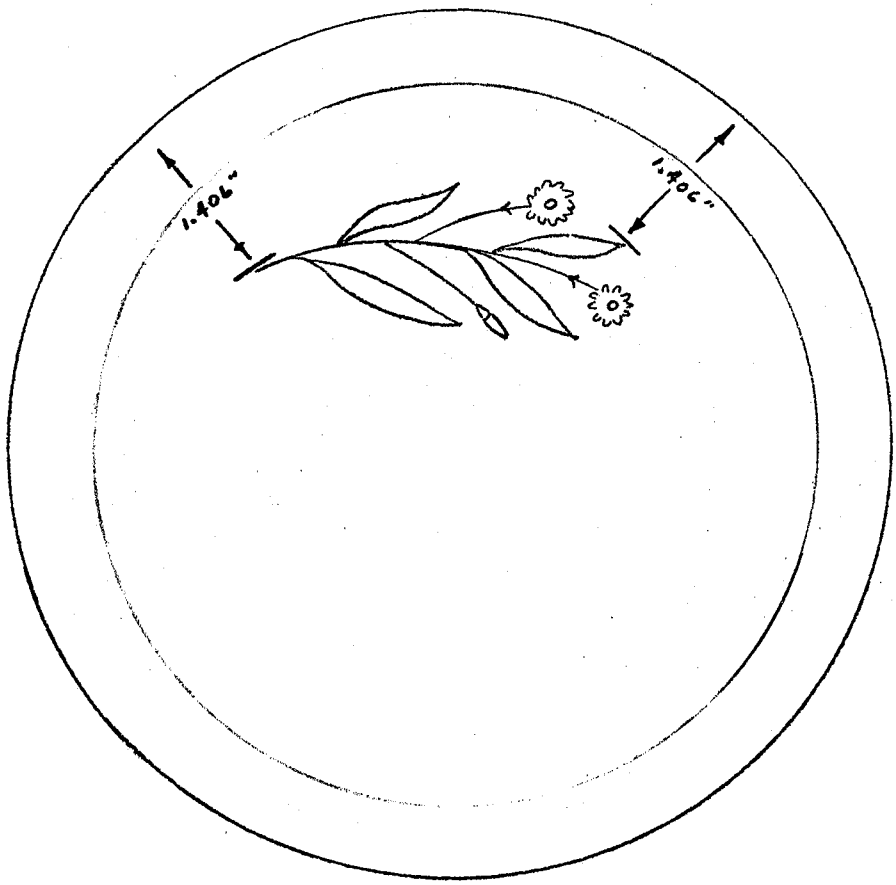


FIGURE 1-E. PLATE, 8-1/4-INCH (MOTIF B)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

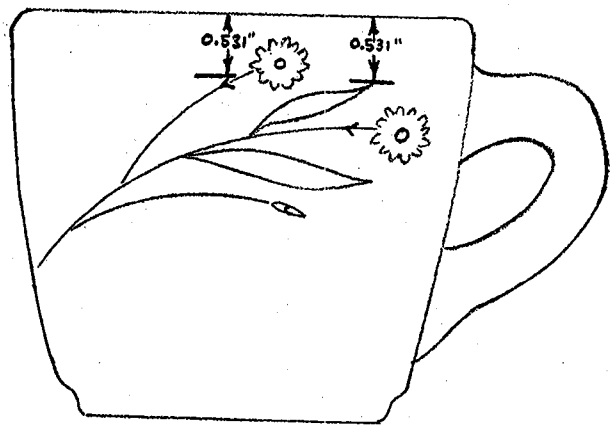


FIGURE 1-F. CUP, COFFEE OR TEA (MOTIF C)

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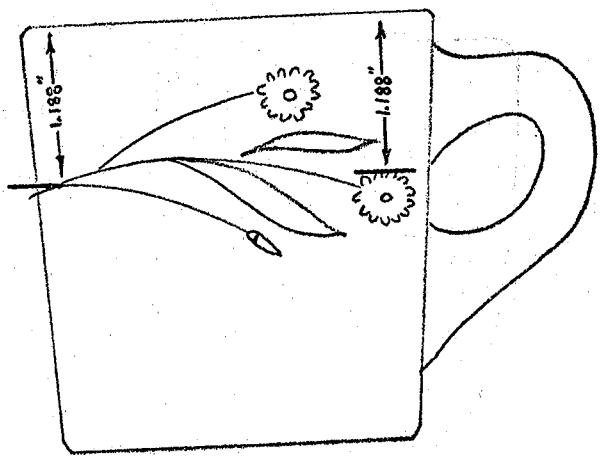


FIGURE 1-G. CUP, MUG (MOTIF C)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:11Z
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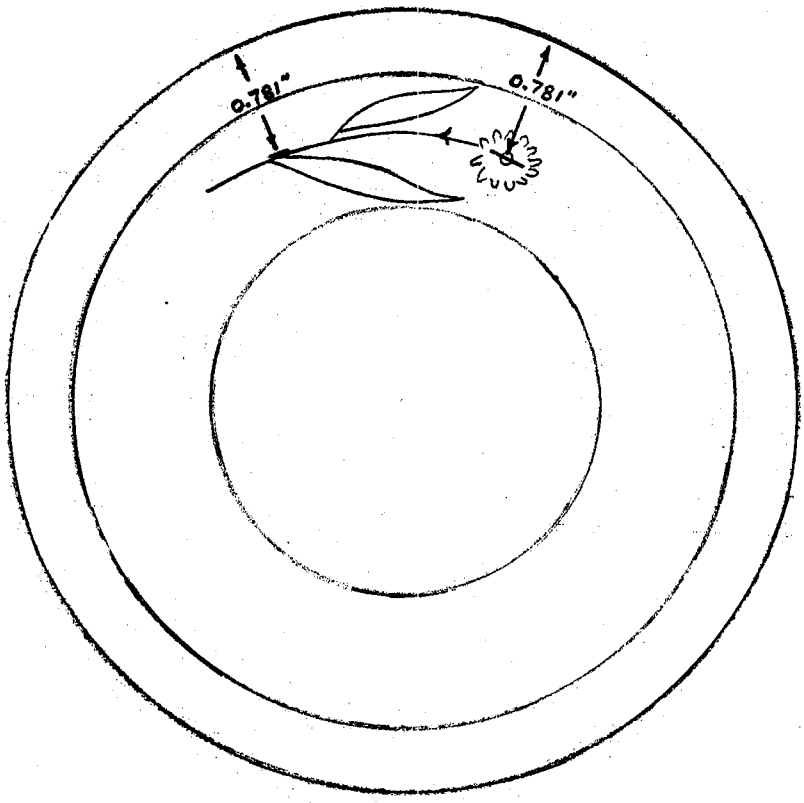


FIGURE 1-H. SAUCER, CUP (MOTIF D)

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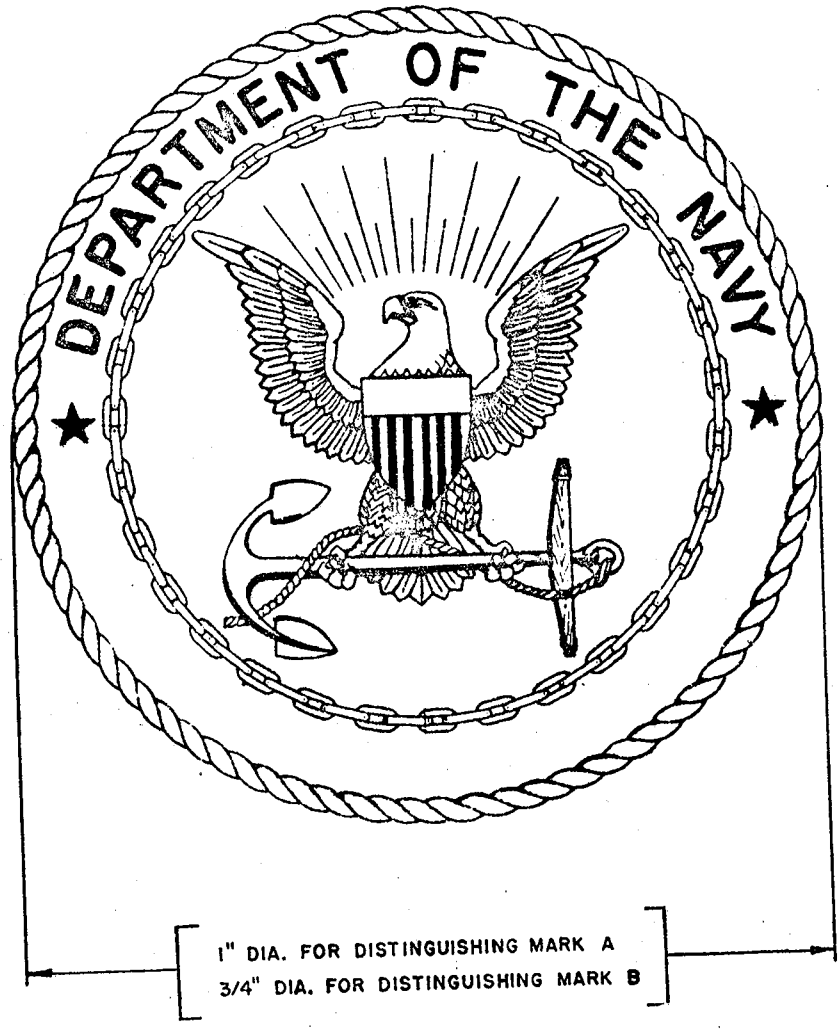


FIGURE 2. DISTINGUISHING MARK - FLAG OFFICERS

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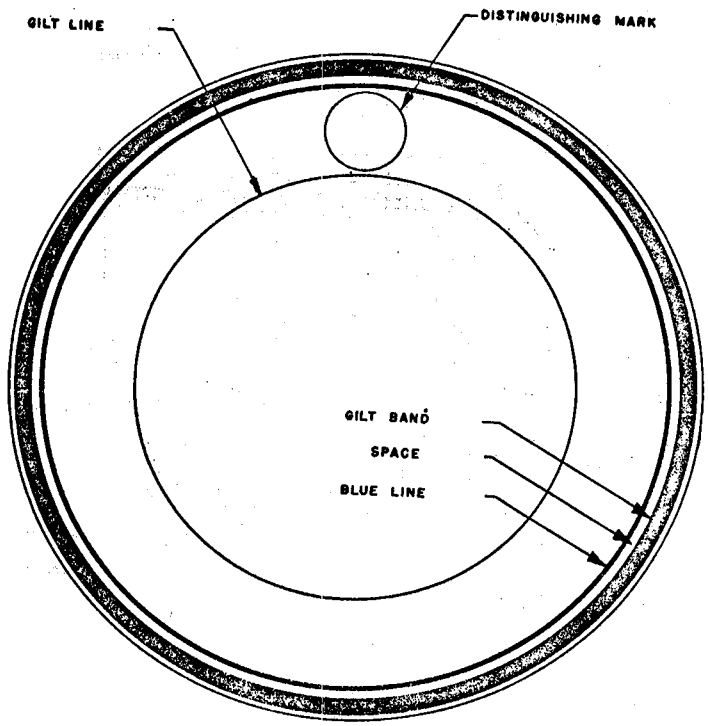


FIGURE 2-A. DECORATION - PLATES

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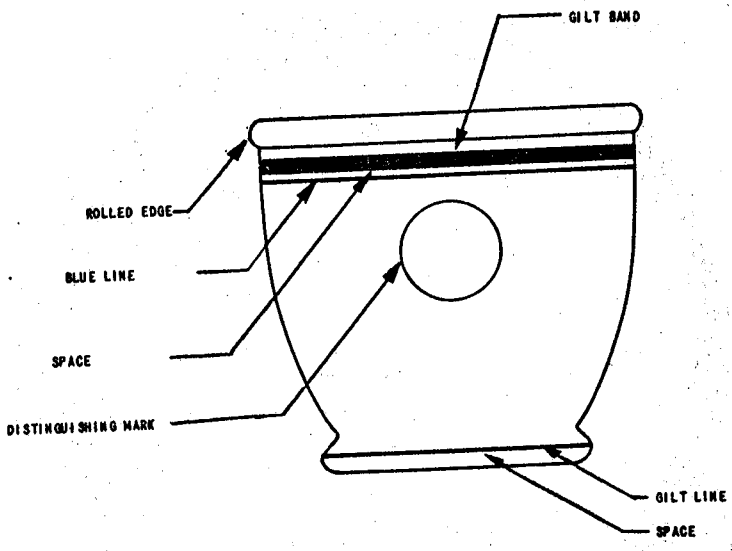


FIGURE 2-B - DECORATION - CUP, EGG

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

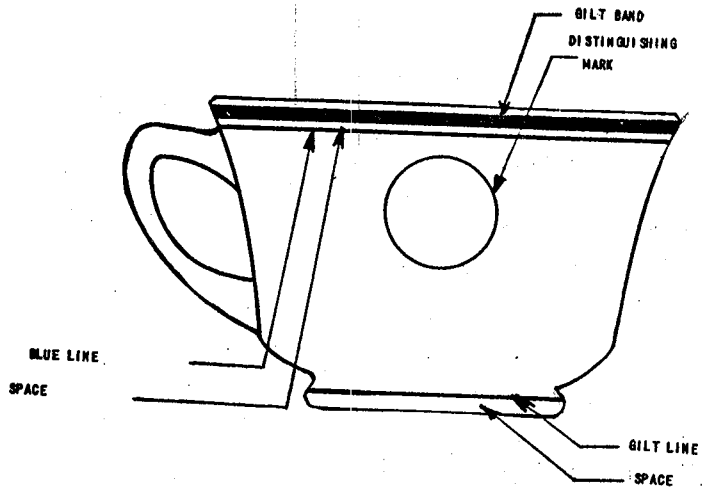


FIGURE 2-C. DECORATION -- CUP, BOUILLON
CUP, COFFEE OR TEA

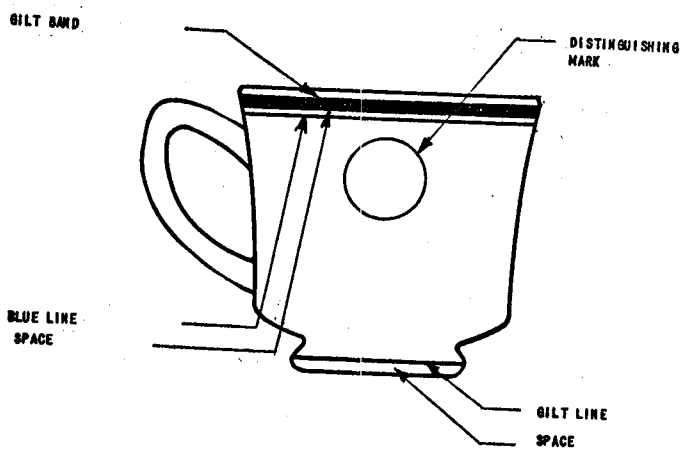


FIGURE 2-D. DECORATION - CUP, DEMITASSE

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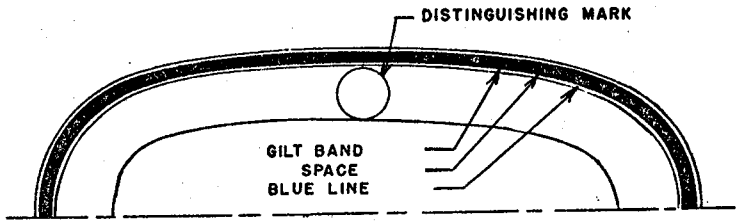


FIGURE 2-E. DECORATION - DISH, PICKLE

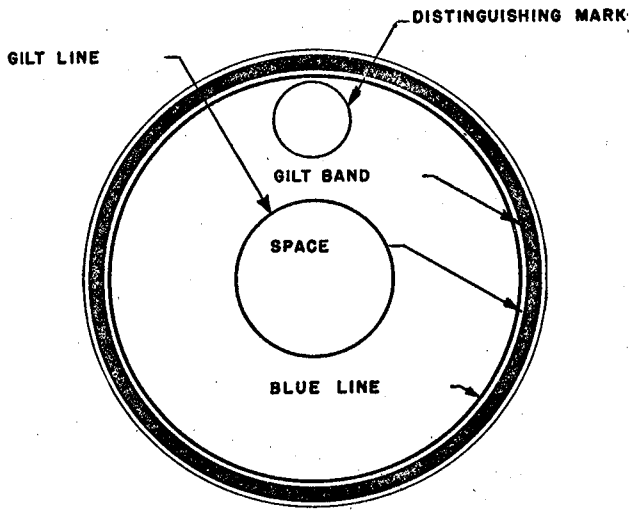
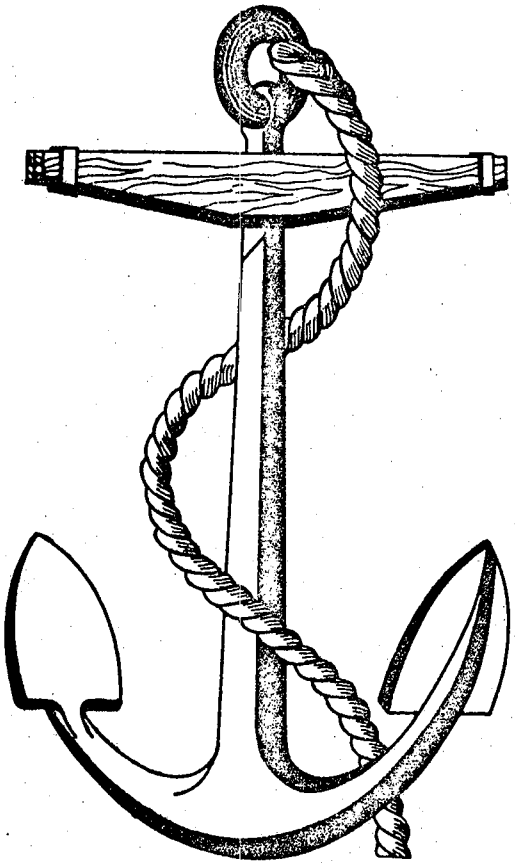
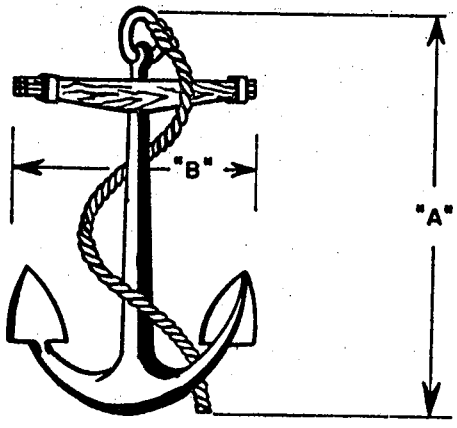


FIGURE 2-F. DECORATION - SAUCER, CUP
SAUCER, CUP (DEMITASSE)

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DISTINGUISHING MARK ENLARGED TO SHOW SHADING AND DETAIL



SIZE	A	B
5	$\frac{9}{16}$"	$\frac{3}{8}$"
6	$\frac{3}{4}$"	$\frac{1}{2}$"

FIGURE 3. DISTINGUISHING MARK - OFFICERS

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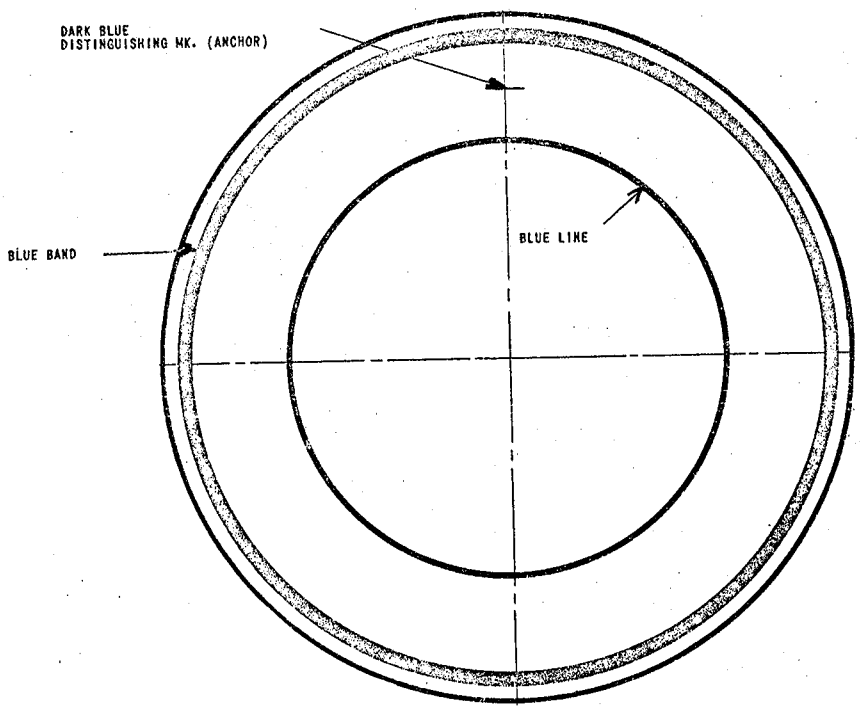


FIGURE 3-A. DECORATION - PLATES

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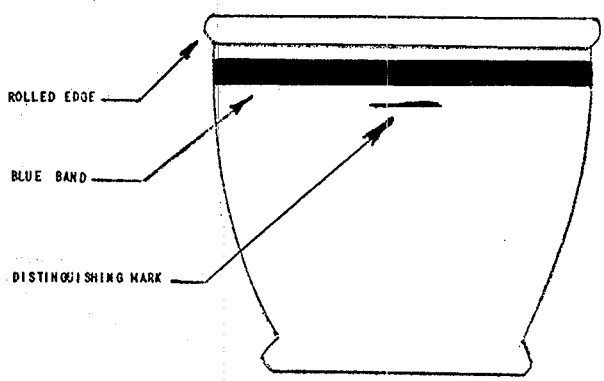


FIGURE 3-B. DECORATION - CUP, EGG

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

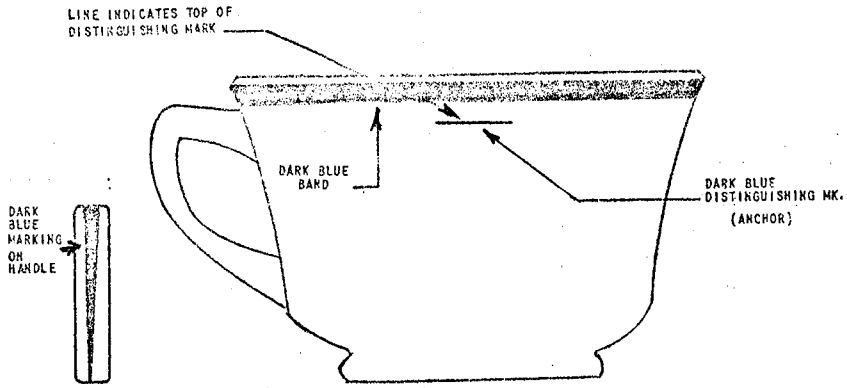


FIGURE 3-C. DECORATION - CUP, BOUILLON
CUP, COFFEE OR TEA

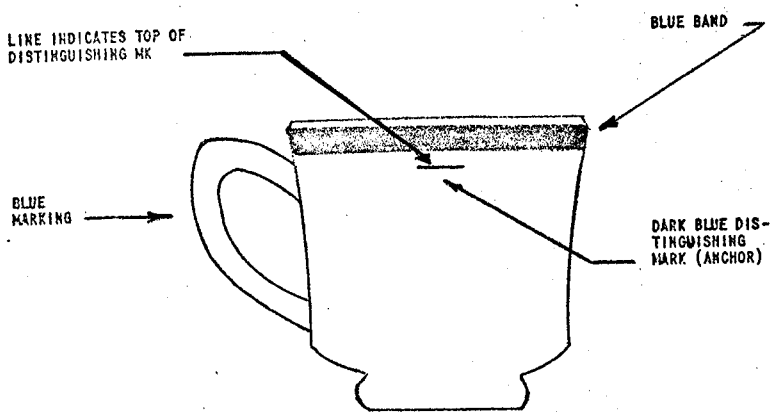


FIGURE 3-D. DECORATION - CUP, DEMITASSE

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Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

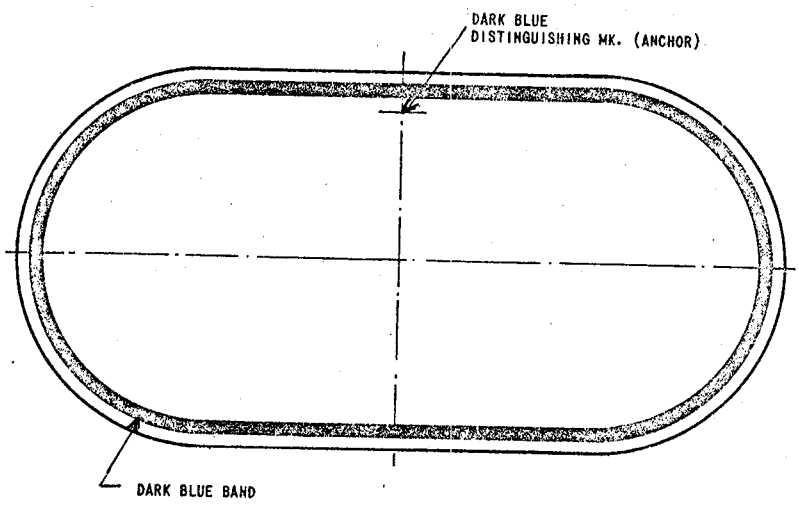


FIGURE 3-E. DECORATION - DISH, PICKLE

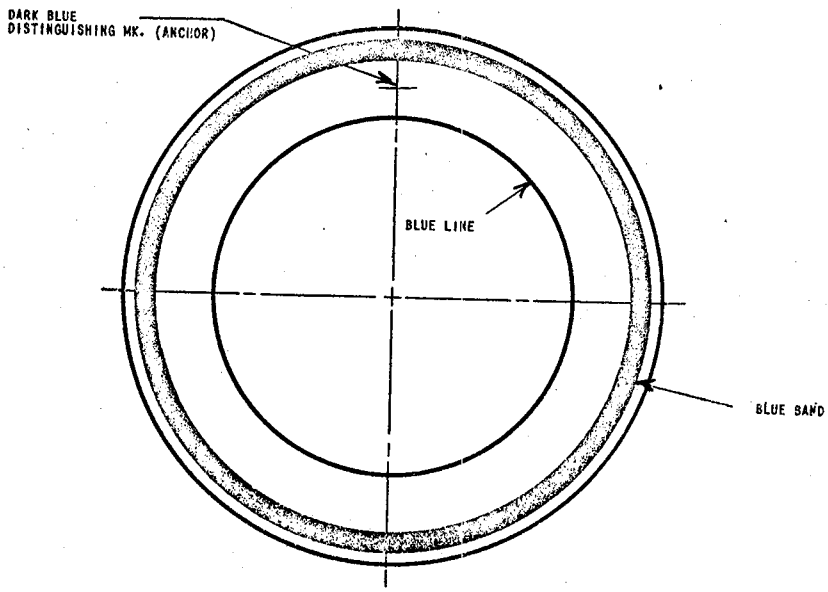
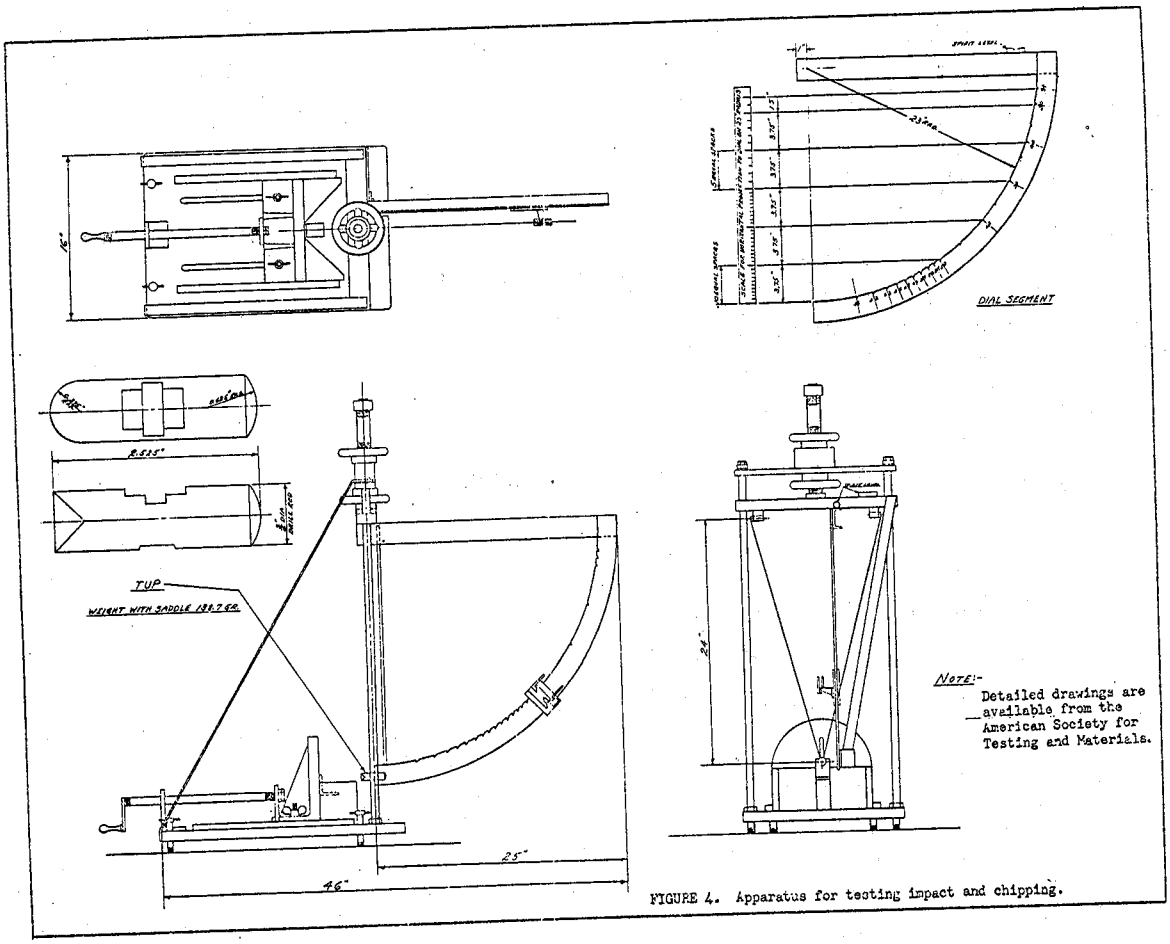


FIGURE 3-F. DECORATION - SAUCER, CUP
SAUCER, CUP (DEMITASSE)
DISH, FRUIT

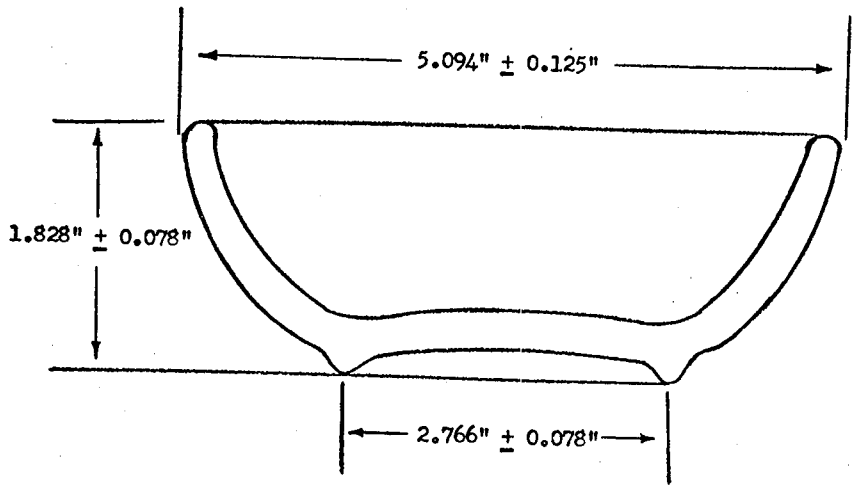
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:11Z
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NOTE:- Detailed drawings are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials.

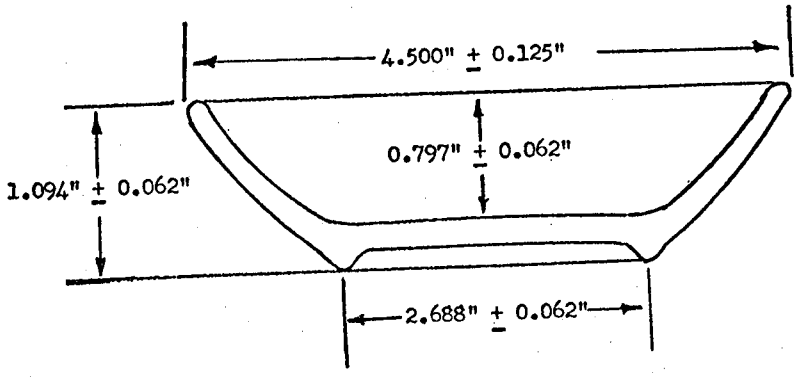
FIGURE 4. Apparatus for testing impact and chipping.

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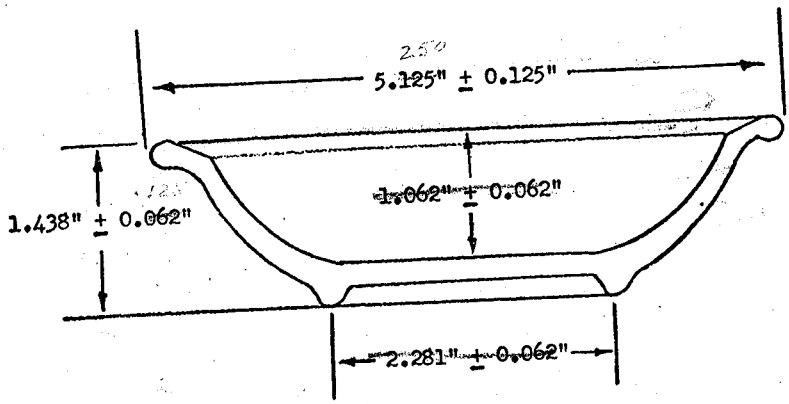


ITEM NO. 4 - BOWL, PLAIN EDGE, SOUP

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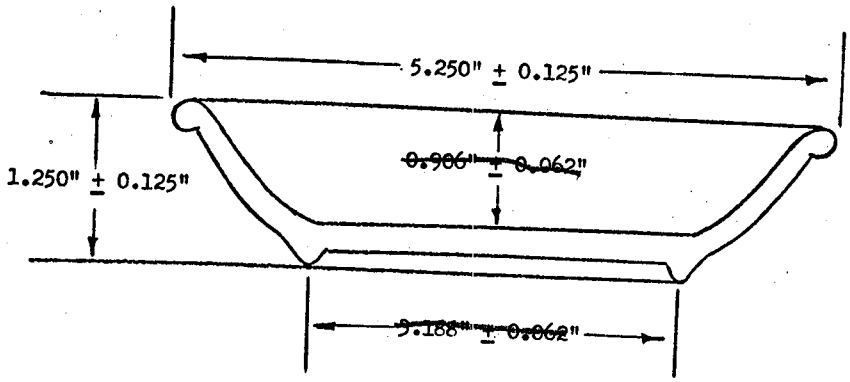


ITEM NO. 6 - DISH, FRUIT, PLAIN EDGE



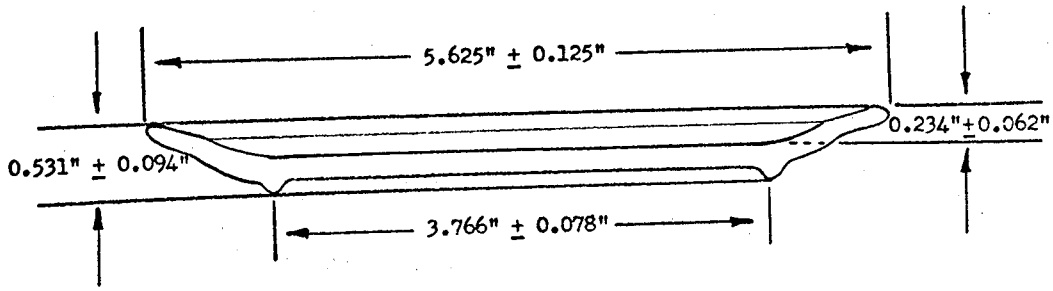
ITEM NO. 8 - DISH, FRUIT, NARROW RIM

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Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

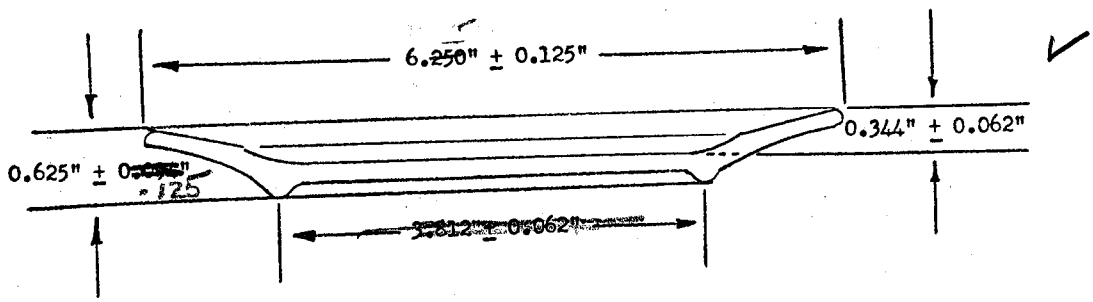


ITEM NO. 9 - DISH, FRUIT, ROLLED EDGE

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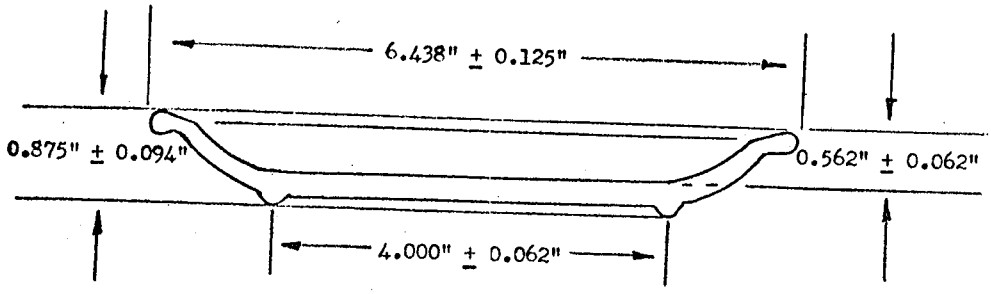


ITEM NO. 10 - PLATE, BREAD AND BUTTER, NARROW RIM

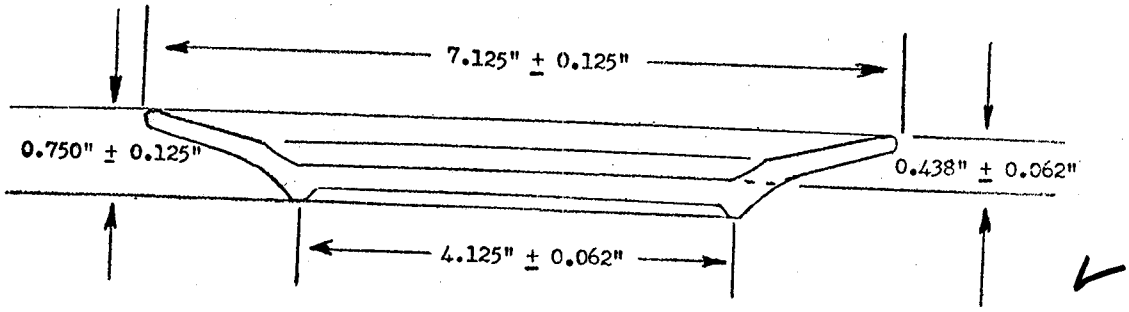


ITEM NO. 12 - PLATE, BREAD AND BUTTER, PLAIN EDGE

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Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

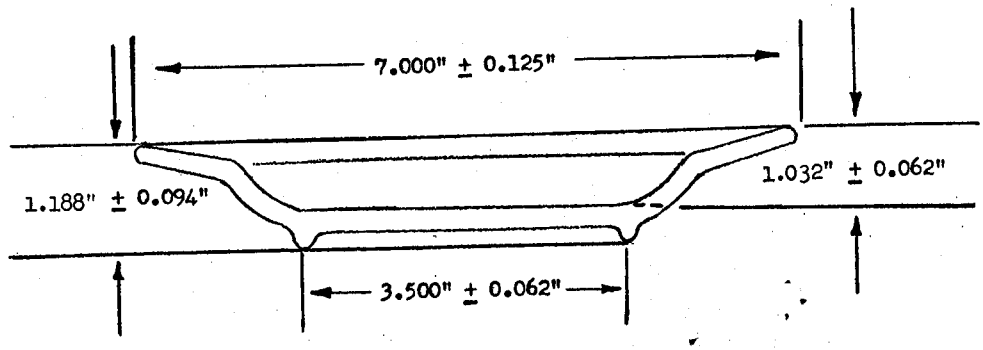


ITEM NO. 13 - PLATE, DESSERT OR SALAD, NARROW RIM

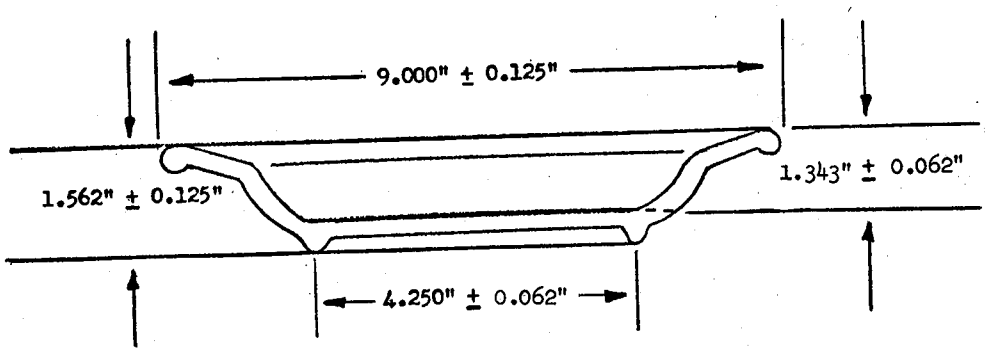


ITEM NO. 16 - PLATE, DESSERT OR SALAD, PLAIN EDGE

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Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

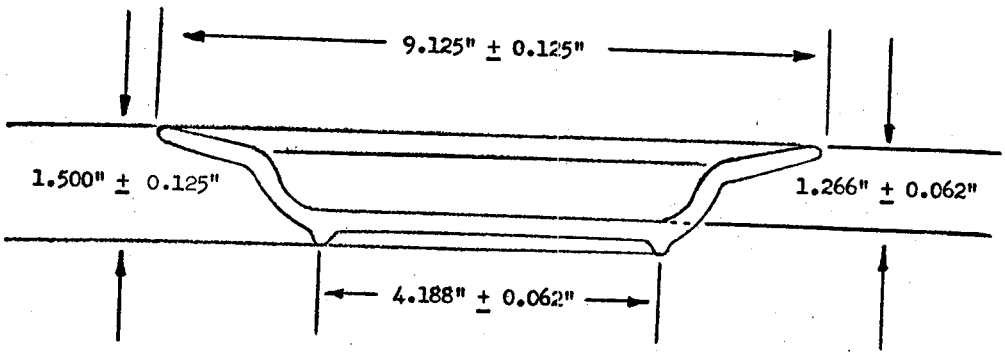


ITEM NO. 18 - PLATE, SOUP OR CEREAL, PLAIN EDGE

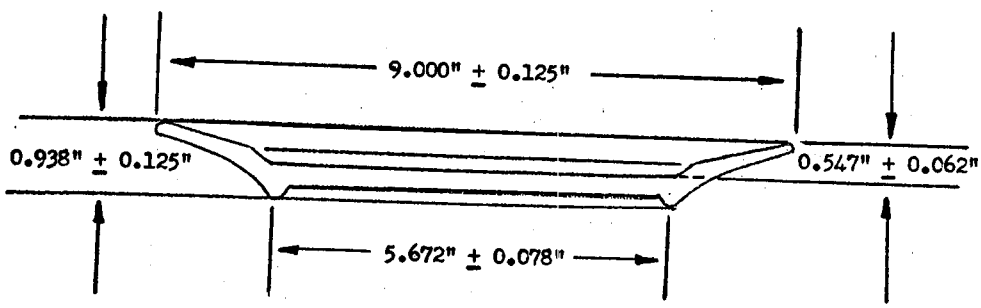


ITEM NO. 19 - PLATE, SOUP, ROLLED EDGE

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Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

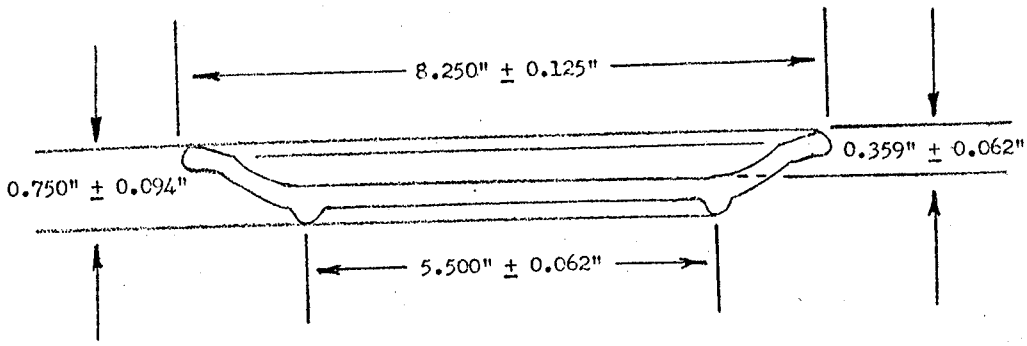


ITEM NO. 20 - PLATE, SOUP, PLAIN EDGE

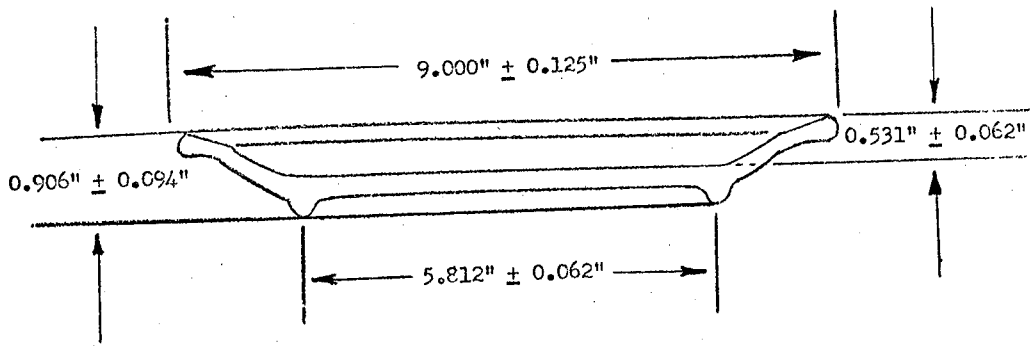


ITEM NO. 21 - PLATE, PLAIN EDGE

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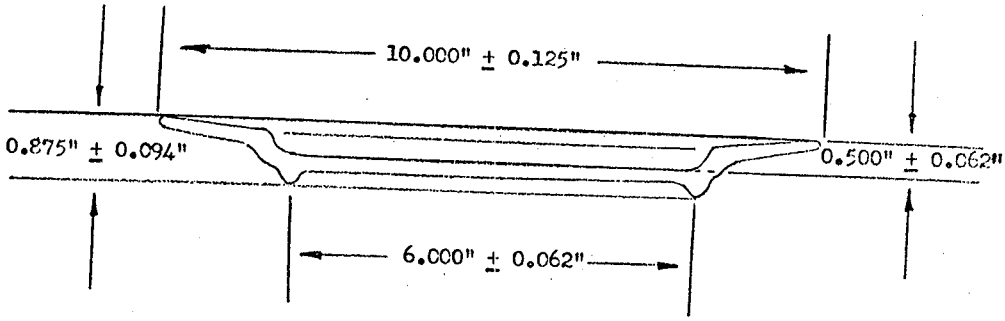


ITEM NO. 22 - PLATE, NARROW RIM

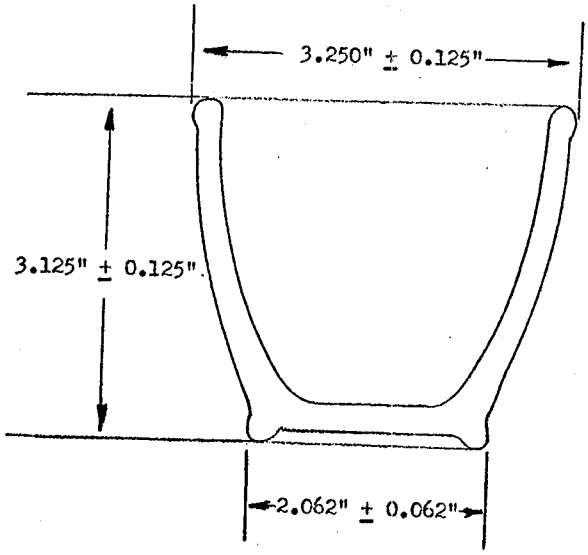


ITEM NO. 25 - PLATE, NARROW RIM

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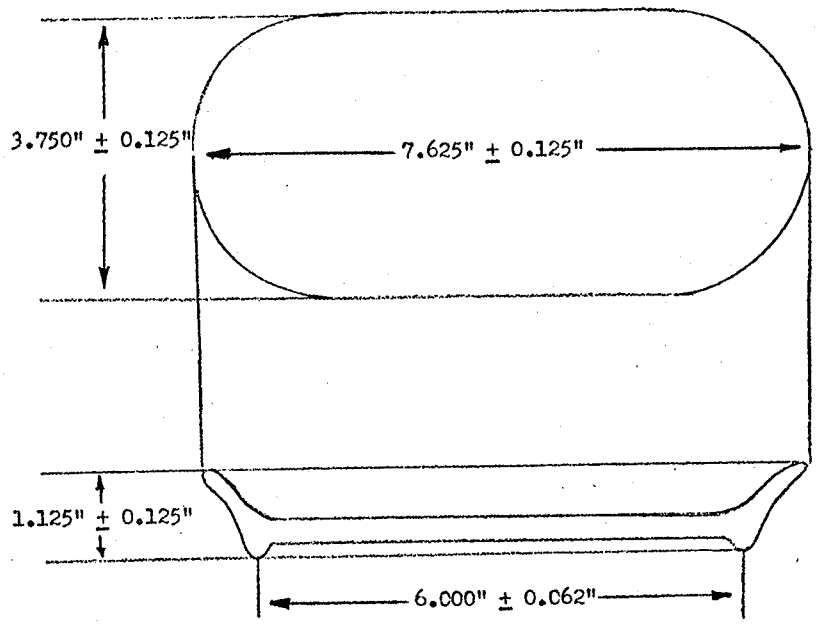


ITEM NO. 26 - PLATE, PLAIN EDGE



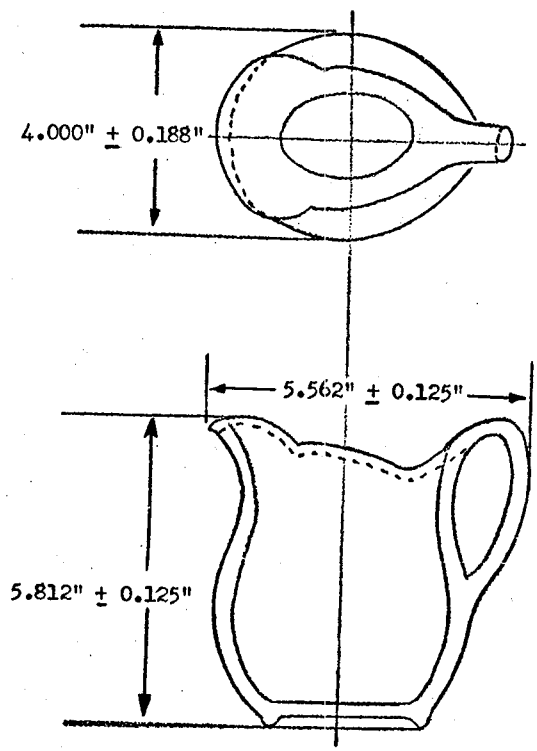
ITEM NO. 27 - CUP, EGG

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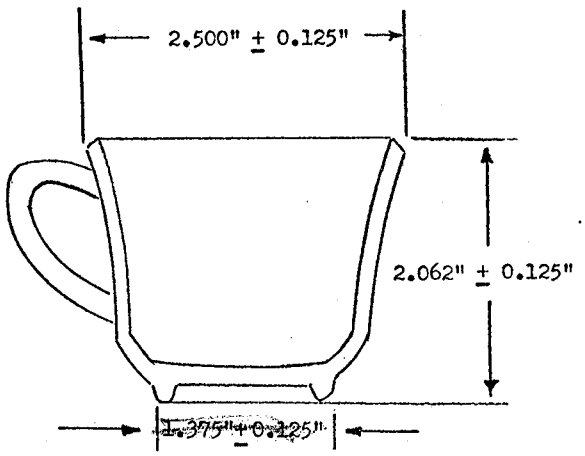
ITEM NO. 31 - TRAY, PICKLE OR CELERY, PLAIN EDGE

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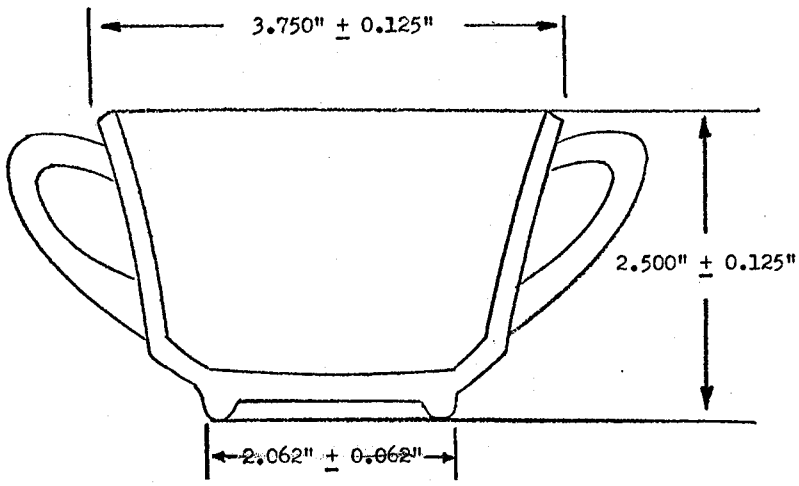


ITEM NO. 38 - PITCHER, CREAM, ROLLED EDGE

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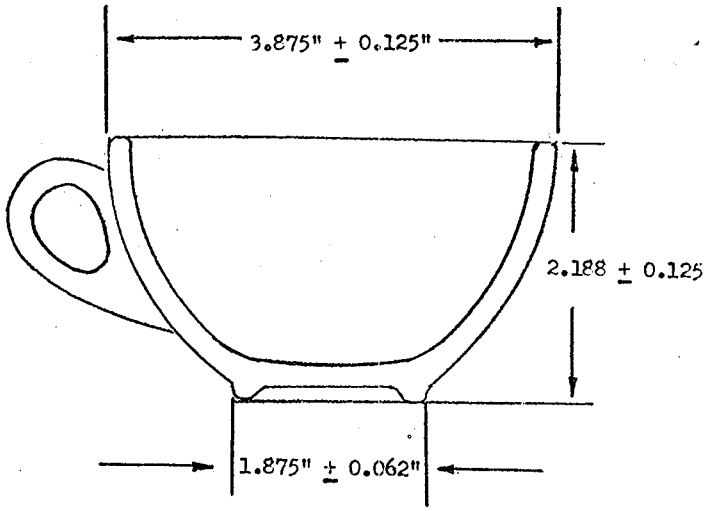


ITEM NO. 39 - CUP, DEMITASSE

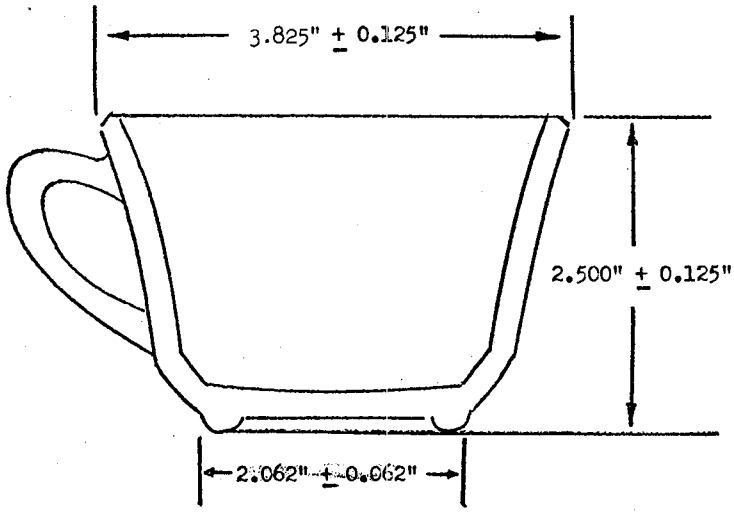


ITEM NO. 42 - CUP, BOUILLON, 2 HANDLES

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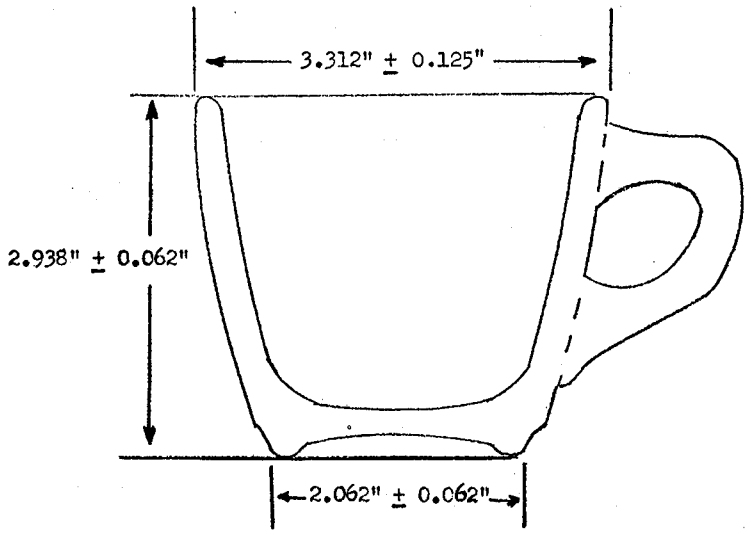


ITEM NO. 44 - CUP, COFFEE OR TEA



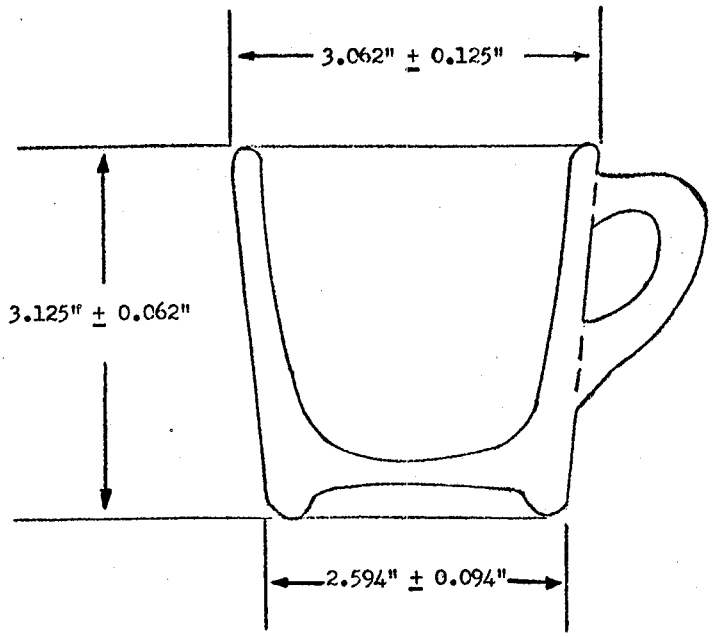
ITEM NO. 45 - CUP, COFFEE OR TEA

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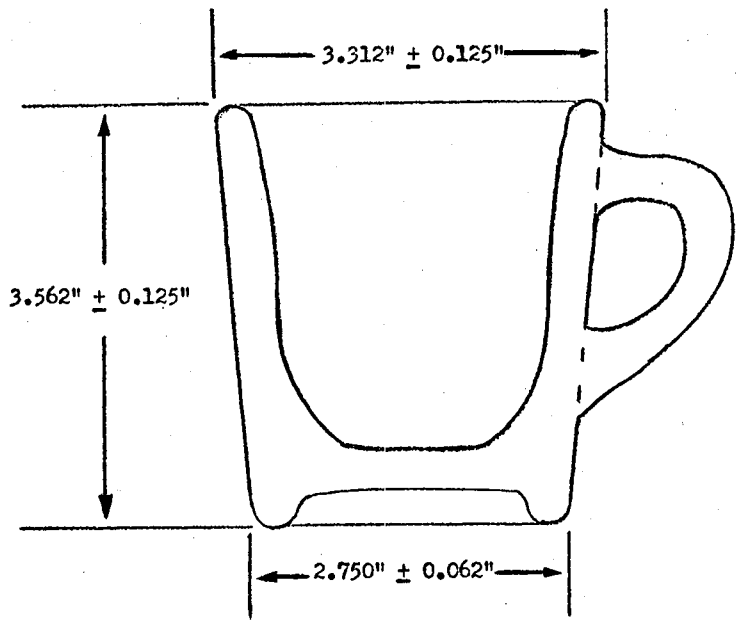


ITEM NO. 46 - CUP, COFFEE OR TEA

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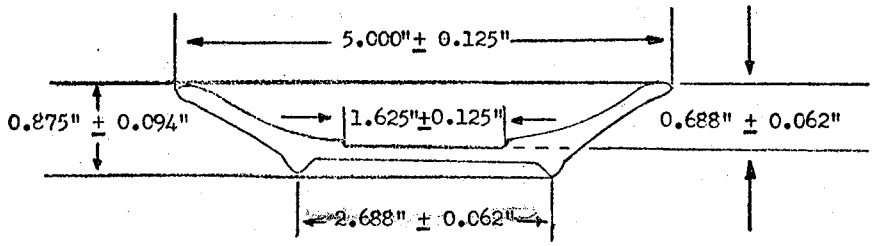


ITEM NO. 47 - CUP, MUG

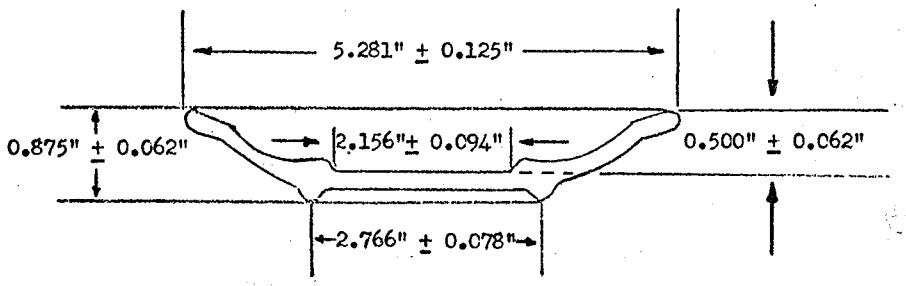


ITEM NO. 48 - CUP, MUG

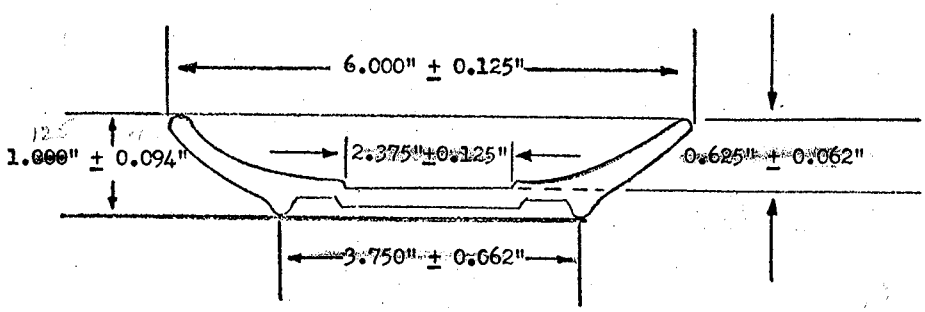
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ITEM NO. 50 - SAUCER, CUP, DEMITASSE, PLAIN EDGE



ITEM NO. 51 - SAUCER, CUP, NARROW RIM



ITEM NO. 55 - SAUCER, CUP, PLAIN EDGE

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 84

Review activities:

Army - GL, MD
Navy - HD, MC, MS

User activities:

Navy - CG
Air Force - 84

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS
HEW-FDA
VA-DMS

TABLE VI. Size, weight, and capacity

Item No.	Article	Nominal outside top diameter (inches)	Weight (ounces) Min.	Weight (ounces) Max.	Capacity (fl. oz.) Min.	Capacity (fl. oz.) Max.
	Eating ware:					
4	Bowl, soup	5-3/32	9	11	11	13
6	Dish, fruit	4-1/2	4-1/4	6		
8	Dish, fruit	5-1/8	8	9		
9	Dish, fruit	5-1/4	8	9		
10	Plate, bread and butter	5-5/8	7	8		
12	Plate, bread and butter	6-1/4	7-1/2	8-1/2		
13	Plate, dessert or salad	6-7/16	9	10		
16	Plate, dessert or salad	7-1/8	10-3/4	11-3/4		
18	Plate, soup or cereal	7	13-1/2	14-1/2		
19	Plate, soup	9	22	24		
20	Plate, soup	9-1/8	22-1/2	24-1/2		
21	Plate, dinner	9	20-1/2	22-1/2		
22	Plate, dinner	8-1/4	17	19		
25	Plate, dinner	9	22	24		
26	Plate, dinner	10	21	23		
27	Cup, egg	3-1/4	9	10	6	7
	Serving ware:					
31	Dish, pickle or celery	7-5/8 x 3-3/4	8-3/4	10		
38	Pitcher, cream	5-9/16 1/	25	28	19	23
	Drinking ware:					
39	Cup, demitasse	2-1/2	2-1/2	3	3	4
42	Cup, bouillon, 2 handles	3-3/4	8	9	7	8
44	Cup, coffee or tea	3-13/16	6-1/2	7-1/2	7	8
45	Cup, coffee or tea	3-7/8	7-1/2	8-1/2	7	8
46	Cup, coffee or tea	3-5/16	10	11	6-7/8	7-7/8
47	Cup, mug	3-1/16	10-1/2	11-1/2	6-1/8	7-1/8
48	Cup, mug	3-5/16	18	20	7-1/2	8-1/2
50	Saucer, cup, demitasse	5	4-3/4	5-1/4		
51	Saucer, cup	5-9/32	7-1/4	8-1/4		
55	Saucer, cup	6	7-1/2	8-1/2		

1/ Includes handle.

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